Gustavo Meza Hinojo

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EDUCATION

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (PUCP) | Lima, Peru **Mar 2014 - Jul 2020**
BSc in Economics
Professional Degree of Licentiate in Economics

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (PUCP) | Lima, Peru **Oct 2022 – Nov 2023**
Specialisation Diploma in Data Science for Social Sciences and Public Management

- Modules: advanced econometrics, machine learning, big data analytics, geospatial analysis and natural language processing, using Python, R and QGIS.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Red de Estudios para el Desarrollo (REDES) | Lima, Peru **May 2023 – Present**
Economic think tank ranked among the five most influential in public policy in Peru

Senior Researcher | Jan 2025 – Present (promoted from Researcher)
Researcher | May 2023 – Dec 2024

- Line manage a team of 3 research assistants, setting priorities, overseeing projects, and strengthening their skills in applied economic research methods.
- Led the full research cycle, from design to publication, of 5 policy briefs on inflation inequality, youth employment, urban poverty, food insecurity and public transport.
- Shape public debate on economic policy as an opinion columnist in El Comercio, Peru's leading newspaper, and through regular media interviews (see Selected Publications & Media).
- Analysed microdata from national household, employment, education and energy surveys to produce policy reports.
- Developed presentations on the economic challenges facing Peru's regions and the public policies needed to improve them, delivered by REDES at 20 events across 8 regional universities since 2023.

Semana Económica | Lima, Peru **Oct 2022 - May 2023**
Peru's leading business and economics magazine

Economic and Financial Analyst | Oct 2022 – May 2023

- Authored more than 60 articles analyzing key policy areas, including monetary policy, fiscal policy, international economics, employment, poverty, and public/private investment.
- Interviewed senior government officials, business leaders and economic and financial experts, and produced charts and data visualizations for the articles.

GĚRENS Escuela de Posgrado | Lima, Peru **Feb 2020 - Oct 2022**
A postgraduate school specializing in management, economics, and natural resource sectors (mining and energy).

Junior Researcher | Jan 2022 – Oct 2022
Consulting Assistant | Dec 2020 – Dec 2021
Intern | Feb 2020 – Nov 2020

- Delivered analysis for 15 consulting and 9 research projects in the energy sector for public and private clients, including the Ministry of Economy and Finance, the Ministry of Energy and Mines and OSINERGMIN, the energy and mining regulator.
    - Reviewed the calculation of regulated natural gas tariffs paid by residential users, and supported the design of a single natural gas tariff to expand household access to natural gas across Peru.
    - Assessed how company mergers in the energy sector would affect competition and, in turn, the energy prices paid by households and businesses.
    - Analysed staffing, pay, bonuses and employment arrangements in local government for the Ministry of Economy and Finance, providing recommendations to improve workforce management
- Applied econometric tools in Stata and R for energy economics research, managing and analyzing national household and energy surveys.
- Authored technical reports and provided analysis on critical policy topics, including the pension system, regional development, and mining/energy regulation.

INDECOPI | Lima, Perú **Jul 2019- Jan 2020**
Peruvian Competition Agency – Technical Secretariat for Free Competition

Intern | Jul 2019 – Jan 2020
- Contributed to technical market studies analyzing competition conditions in the port sector and international maritime freight transport in Peru.
- Processed and analyzed datasets to support antitrust investigations conducted by the Technical Secretariat.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND MEDIA (IN SPANISH)

Selected Policy briefs: Fiscal burden of Peru's mining sector: a Latin American comparison [(2022) - Link]; Welfare effects of formal public transport on users [(2023) - Link]; Policies to improve youth labour market entry in Peru [(2026) - Link].

Opinion: "Más oportunidades para los jóvenes" (Youth employment), Aug 2024; "Inversión privada que no repunta" (Stagnant private investment), Oct 2024; "El relevo que el agro sigue esperando" (Ageing in agriculture), Nov 2025; "¿Condición biológica o condiciones iniciales?" (Gender gaps in science and employment), Apr 2025; "La pobreza está en las ciudades" (Urban poverty), May 2025.

Feature articles (Semana Económica): "La recuperación del empleo formal adoptaría un ritmo más moderado" (Formal employment recovery), Nov 2022; "Sistema Privado de Pensiones: los factores que lo hacen insostenible a largo plazo" (Pension system sustainability), Jan 2023; "Pobreza en aumento: los factores que elevarían las cifras del 2022" (Rising poverty), Feb 2023; "Moneda común en Sudamérica: ¿es viable su implementación?" (South American common currency), Feb 2023.

Media interviews: Gestión – economic cost and effectiveness of states of emergency against crime, Oct 2025; El Comercio – regional governments' capacity to execute public investment, Oct 2025; Gestión – public transport and quality of life in Lima, Dec 2023.

SKILLS, LANGUAGES

Statistical Software: Stata (Advanced), EViews (Intermediate), SPSS.
Data Science & Programming: Python (Intermediate), R (Intermediate), QGIS (Geospatial Analysis).
Methodologies: Microeconometrics, Impact Evaluation (RDD, DiD, IV), Machine Learning for Public Policy, Survey Design.
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (Advanced / Fluent - TOEFL iBT Score: 118, Mar 2026).